

10 Ways to Go Green and Save Money at the Same Time

Want to help the environment, but not too keen on all of the expensive suggestions floating around out there? Here are 10 frugal ways to incorporate green living into your life without throwing your well-laid budget plans to the wind.

1. Safety razors

Giving up disposable razors for the old-fashioned safety razor is a great way to save money and the environment. The multipacks of flat razor blades are not only inexpensive, but they come without all of the extra plastic housing that ultimately ends up in landfills. We've been doing this in our house for a few years now, and have noticed a tremendous savings. An added bonus? We don't have to carve out extra storage in the cabinets when we stock up. Flat packs of blades store very efficiently in a minimal amount of space.

2. Mineral salt deodorant sticks

You can find these at nearly any health food or natural living store. They last an incredibly long time, don't contain any harmful ingredients, and as with the safety razor idea listed above, don't come with a ton of obnoxious plastic packaging to toss in the landfill. My husband and I used this product on a six-month trip around the world. It lasted the duration of the trip and is still going strong. It also takes up minimal room in the backpack.

3. Reusable coffee filters

Just imagine never having to buy or run out of these babies again!

4. Give up paper towels

Okay, I'll be honest. This is not easy in the beginning. The trick is developing a simple, workable system for having clean rags on hand. To store clean rags, I'm using several of those fabric sleeves with elastic on both ends. You know, the kind most people use to store empty plastic grocery bags for quick access? I hung one in each place we routinely used paper towels. Then, I raided the pile of old T-shirts we had set aside to go to Goodwill and cut up a bunch of cleaning rags. These were